

Windows 8 in October

Microsoft is apparently on track for shipping Windows 8 tablets and PCs in October 2012



Corsair Flash Voyager USB 3.0

Corsair has launched its 16GB and 32GB Flash Voyager USB 3.0 drives in India, priced at ₹1,599 and ₹2,199. <http://dgit.in/GMkeTK>

Blu-ray Player Test

takes longer to boot and takes more time to start playback of a Blu-ray movie. This difference comes down quite a bit when we compare playback off a USB drive and off a DVD, but the BDP3200 still has the advantage. Another thing we didn't like about the BD75 is the interface. The icons are laid out in an east-west-north-south design, and to select any one, you need to press the necessary direction key on the remote and the item gets selected automatically. Quite neat, but if you're new to the interface you'll inevitably press the select key, which would take you straight into the settings folder. This player also won't play back some MP4 files. We liked the upscalability quality though, particularly of slightly older (we're talking about years 2007-2008) videos on AVI format. Panasonic's remote is slightly more cluttered, and some of the keys can't really be remembered by touch. You'll

have to look down at the remote to operate most of the time. The smartphone remote has a very neat look to it, and works well the moment the device is connected to the network.

Now, let's delve into the category of Blu-ray players that also have the 3D video playback capability. All these players will have integrated Wi-Fi capabilities as well.

Philips' BDP5200 has a significantly different UI than its younger sibling, the BDP3200. You might think that it will largely be the same since they're in the same family, but only the colour theme is similar. Since this has a few more web services, the layout is quite different. The remote remains the same as the BDP3200, which we had appreciated for being comfortable to use and recall. Setting up the Wi-Fi is a simple task. This has a fairly quick startup time, slightly quicker than its sibling. Blu-ray playback is very similar as well, and with similar

video and picture settings, they look just the same in terms of the final output. 3D playback is impressive. This player literally read every MKV, MP4 and AVI file we threw at it, be it from a DVD or a USB drive. Sadly, there's no AVCHD support, but knowing Philips, it might just come with a firmware upgrade in the future. A USB drive, even up to 500GB portable ones – the Blu-ray player read all them with ease. Net TV

load it thrice, the download didn't begin. We also switched from Wi-Fi to LAN for our third attempt, but that didn't help either. Rather than risk bricking the unit, in the end we decided to continue with the tests. The BD670 had the quickest boot time and the quickest startup time for a Blu-ray disc. While we didn't get the apps store on the player, there was a Premium section. The content – news, updates,



Panasonic DMP-BD110

services include YouTube, Dailymotion, Funspot etc, but are largely region specific. You won't get to access all the services on the platform in all the regions. We faced no connectivity issues, and the videos would stream as smoothly as on a PC.

We had high hopes from the LG BD670, particularly because it promised a wholesome app store experience over and above all its features. To start off, we liked the Blu-ray and 3D playback quality. The interface is the most colourful among all the Blu-ray players we tested here. However, it tends to hang quite a bit. The player hung twice as we tried to play AVI and MKV files off a USB drive. The promised app store wasn't a part of the firmware that was on the device. To test the app store we searched for an update. We were immediately shown one and were prompted to download it. However, despite trying to down-

photo galleries and videos – was powered by Indiatimes. Navigating through the premium section was painful. It was quite slow, and certainly not due to the broadband speed, which was a consistent 2Mbps throughout the tests. Overall, this Blu-ray player was a bit of a disappointment, and we honestly hope the issues are solved in a future software update. After all, this player has quick boot and playback start times, very good playback quality and the interface is something that all other Blu-ray players should learn from.

Finally, the full-fledged Blu-ray player in this test is the Panasonic DMP-BD110. Given its company at the moment, this is one unique product. You know why? This is a 3D Blu-ray player that also allows you to upscale 2D videos to 3D. No other Blu-ray player does that. However, it

WHAT TO EXPECT

Philips BDP3200

- Wide compatibility with video formats
- Comfortable remote
- Visually unappealing UI

Sony BDP S380

- Quick boot time
- PS3-esque UI helps with quick navigation
- Well built
- Lack of DivX – most AVI videos won't play

Panasonic BD75

- Customisable UI
- Refusal to sometimes return back to Home menu on stopping BD playback
- Incompatibility with some AVI and MP4 formats

- Won't display some JPG images

Philips BDP5200

- Compatibility with all video formats
- Comfortable remote
- Basic bland-looking UI

LG BD670

- Quick boot time
- Visually appealing UI
- USB port cover
- Intermittently hanging UI
- Incompatibility with playing back some MP4 video formats

Panasonic BD110

- 2D content upscalable to 3D
- Refusal to read certain USB drives in Fat32/ NTFS format